



Easy Annotate

● FREE RESOURCE GUIDE

Free PDF Books & Ready-to-Use **Assignments**

8 legitimate, no-cost sources for classroom texts — plus 5 public-domain readings already paired with a writing prompt, ready to drop straight into Easy Annotate.

8

SOURCES

5

READY PAIRINGS

easy-annotate.com

8 Places to Find Free PDF Books

Every source below is free, legal, and currently live — no library card, no trial, no account required unless noted. "PDF" tag means the site offers a direct PDF download; others export as EPUB or plain text, which Easy Annotate can still open.

01

Project Gutenberg [gutenberg.org](https://www.gutenberg.org) PDF & TXT

70,000+ public-domain ebooks — the largest free classic-literature library online. Search by title, then choose "Plain Text UTF-8" or download as EPUB and convert. Best for: full novels, classic short stories, poetry collections, grades 6–12.

02

Standard Ebooks [standardebooks.org](https://www.standardebooks.org) EPUB & PDF

Volunteer-typeset, professionally formatted public-domain classics — a much cleaner reading experience than raw Gutenberg text. Smaller catalog, higher polish. Best for: assigning a text you want to actually look good on screen.

03

CommonLit [commonlit.org](https://www.commonlit.org) FREE ACCOUNT

Leveled fiction, nonfiction, and poetry built specifically for classroom use, each with built-in discussion questions. Free teacher account required; texts download as PDF. Best for: grade-appropriate short passages, grades 3–12.

04

ReadWorks [readworks.org](https://www.readworks.org) FREE ACCOUNT

Nonfiction and fiction reading passages with comprehension questions, organized by grade and Lexile level. Free account required; PDF export built in. Best for: shorter nonfiction passages, grades K–8.

4 More Sources

These lean more toward nonfiction, textbooks, and archival material — useful when a class needs something other than a classic novel.

05

OpenStax openstax.org PDF

Free, peer-reviewed college and high school textbooks — biology, history, government, psychology, and more. Every title has a direct PDF download, no account needed. Best for: full-length nonfiction/textbook excerpts, grades 9–12.

06

CK-12 ck12.org FREE ACCOUNT

Free, standards-aligned textbooks (FlexBooks), strongest in math and science. Chapters can be exported individually. Best for: shorter STEM reading assignments, grades 6–12.

07

Internet Archive archive.org PDF

Millions of scanned books, including many public-domain titles with direct PDF download. Some newer titles are borrow-only (14-day loan) rather than downloadable — check the item page for a "Download Options" panel before assigning.

08

Open Library / DPLA openlibrary.org · dp.la SEARCH TOOLS

Not sources themselves — these are search engines across thousands of digitized library and archive collections. Use them to find a specific title, then follow the link to whichever archive actually hosts it (often Internet Archive or Gutenberg).

5 Text + Assignment Pairings

All five are confirmed public domain and free on Project Gutenberg — search the title, download the plain text, and open it in Easy Annotate. Each pairing includes a reading focus (what to have students react/annotate around) and a writing prompt for after.

The Tell-Tale Heart

Edgar Allan Poe · short story, ~2,200 words

GRADES 7–10

Reading focus: Have students react to moments where the narrator insists he is *not* mad — what does the language reveal that he doesn't intend to?

Writing prompt: Is this narrator reliable? Use two specific moments from the text to support your answer.

The Gift of the Magi

O. Henry · short story, ~2,100 words

GRADES 6–9

Reading focus: Mark each moment that hints at the twist before it's revealed — what clues are hidden in plain sight?

Writing prompt: Was the sacrifice worth it? Write a short response arguing your position using evidence from the ending.

The Story of an Hour

Kate Chopin · short story, ~1,000 words

GRADES 9–12

Reading focus: Annotate the shift in Mrs. Mallard's emotions paragraph by paragraph — where exactly does the tone change?

Writing prompt: Explain the irony of the final line in one paragraph, then rewrite the story's last sentence from a different character's point of view.

2 More Pairings

The Road Not Taken

Robert Frost · poem, 20 lines

GRADES 5–9

Reading focus: Highlight every word or phrase connected to choice, doubt, or looking back — then react to how the poem's last two lines land differently than the rest.

Writing prompt: Describe a real choice you made between two options. What made you decide, and do you think about the other path?

Alice's Adventures in Wonderland (Ch. 1–2)

Lewis Carroll · excerpt, ~2,600 words

GRADES 4–7

Reading focus: Mark every place the ordinary rules of size, time, or logic get broken — how does Alice react each time?

Writing prompt: Invent your own "Drink Me" or "Eat Me" object. What would it do, and how would you react if you found it?

A note on copyright

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